



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

May 2017

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for June/July is
May 19

Contributions may be brought to the
office or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org
3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:00 am Education and Fellowship

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.



Minnehaha Happenings in May

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
	1 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p UMW Leadership 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Finance	2 Kitchen reserved 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters (Taleweavers)	3 10a Staff Meeting 1p M'haha circle 5p Methodicals 5:30p Enchilada dinner 6p Children's Musical Rehearsal 6p United or Divided Methodist Church 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	4 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Gospel of John 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6p Social Security Strategy presentation	5 9a Brighter Minds 10a AI-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p NAMI (additional) 6:30p NAMI (additional) 6:30p RCA	6 8a Plant delivery 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 9a UMW Greatest Generation Celebration and Salad Luncheon 5p Childcare Night
7 9a Worship with Organ and Choir 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship w/Band 6p Living Brave Women's Group 6p Youth & Confirmation Classes 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA 7p Venturing Crew	8 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Cub Scouts	9 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council	10 9:30a Nokomis Circle 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed Night Dinner 6p Children's Musical Rehearsal 6:15p Children's Programming 6:45p Chancel Choir	11 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Gospel of John 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	12 9a Brighter Minds 10a AI-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taizé	13 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
14 Mother's Day 9a Worship with Organ and Choir 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship w/Band 4p Youth Council 6p Youth Night (grades 6-12) 7p Pack 1 Planning 7p SAA	15 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Women's Soul Group	16 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters (Taleweavers) 6:30p Worship Committee	17 Children's Musical Rehearsal 5p Methodicals 5:30p Wed Night Dinner 6p Children's Musical Rehearsal 6:15p Children's Programming 6:45p Chancel Choir	18 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a Gospel of John 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	19 <i>Newsletter items due</i> 9a Brighter Minds 10a AI-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	20 Armed Forces Day Children's Musical Rehearsal 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
21 10a Children's Sunday 2p Sweet Land Trip 6p Living Brave Women's Group 6:30p UMW Simpson Meal Prep 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	22 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 5:45p UMW Simpson Shelter 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Cub Scouts	23 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	24 5p Methodicals 6p Will Party 6:45p Chancel Choir	25 Ascension 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Play-date 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	26 9a Brighter Minds 9a Newsletter Collation 10a AI-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	27 6a Joy Catering 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
28 10a Memorial Sunday 7p SAA	29 Memorial Day 10a OA 1:30p AI-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	30 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters (Taleweavers)	31 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	Notes:		

Worship in May

We are in the season of Easter! The Easter seasons lasts for 7 weeks (including Easter Sunday), and the gospel stories focus on God's presence with us throughout time. In addition, we'll be celebrating some special events. May 21 is the Children's Musical, "What's Up, Zak?" with one worship service at 10:00. In fact, we have four weeks in a row of one worship service at 10:00 – May 21 through June 11. Pentecost (the birthday of the church) is on June 4, and June 11 is our service honoring high school graduating seniors. See articles elsewhere in the newsletter for June 4 where you are encouraged to wear red, bring your bike helmet for a blessing, and join in a potluck following the service.

7th	"If It Smells Like a Sheep"	John 10:1-10
14th	"Where's My Room?"	John 14:1-14
21st	Children's Musical – "What's Up, Zak?" One Service 10:00 am.	
28th	"The God of the Old Testament?"	Psalms 68:3-10

Future Special Events at Minnehaha UMC—Save the Date

- June 4 – One worship service at 10:00 – Blessing of bike helmets and picnic outside following the service
- June 11 – One worship service at 10:00 – Graduation Sunday
- June 18 – Outdoor 10:30 worship begins
- June 20-22 – Annual Conference in St. Cloud
- June 19-23 – Music and Drama Camp
- June 21-23 – Vacation Bible School
- July 16-18 – Minnehaha Adventure Camp for youth going into grades 6-7 at Koinonia Retreat Center
- July 23-28 – Minnehaha Wilderness Camp for youth going into grades 8-12 (plus recent graduates) at Star Lake Wilderness Camp
- July 30 – Cowboy Sunday at 10:30 service
- August 6 – Worship at Minnehaha Falls at 10:30
- August – Collection of school supplies and backpacks for MinneHarvest clients
- August 20 – Blessing of backpacks in worship
- August 27 – Blessing of Animals at 10:30 service
- Sept. 3 – One worship service at 10:00 inside
- Sept. 10 – One worship service at 10:00 outside



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11 am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by
Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

R E M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER**

ARTICLES IS

May 19

The June/July 2017 issues are combined
and will be sent the last week of May.

Youth Ministries

**Here is a look forward at the next month for our Youth program. We have a lot of activities coming up for our Youth and volunteers with opportunities to Seek, Serve, and to Celebrate!
All the things we do best here at Minnehaha.**

April 30th- Youth are giving Bibles to 2nd Graders

April 30th – Youth Group: Goes from 6:00-7:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be working on the newest edition of "Youth News". The older class will be meeting in the Wesley Room and will be discussing the Sacraments: Baptism.

May 2nd – Enchilada rolling night: Youth and Parents are encouraged to meet in the kitchen from 6-7pm to help roll enchiladas for the Youth fundraiser the following night.

May 3rd – Enchilada Dinner fundraiser night: Youth are serving Enchiladas from 5:00-7:00 in the kitchen to help raise money for the youth program. Please bring the family and invite everyone you know to come and eat Rick Anderson's delicious enchiladas and help support our amazing program!

May 7th - Youth Group: Goes from 6:00-7:30pm. The younger class will be meeting in the 3rd floor Youth room and will be working on the newest edition of "Youth News". The older class will be meeting in the Wesley Room and will be discussing the Sacraments: Communion

May 14th - Youth night: For our final Youth Night outing before summer, youth have chosen to go to Grand Slam Sports and Entertainment. We will be leaving the church at 5pm (so try to get to Minnehaha a few minutes early) and will be back by 8pm. Cost is \$16 and includes Unlimited Laser tag, Mini golf, and Krazy Karts, as well as a slice of pizza and soda, and six arcade tokens! What a fantastic deal! We are expecting a large group to attend, so PLEASE be sure to RSVP so that we have enough transportation available. Thank you!

Rick's Wild Rice Enchilada Dinner

This is a fund Raiser for Minnehaha Youth Programs

On: May 3, 2017

Serving Time: 5:00 pm to 7:00 pm

Cost: Adults - \$10.00
Kids 6 – 12 - \$5.00
Kids under 6 free
Family max - \$30.00



Menu - Wild Rice & Chicken Enchiladas
Vegetarian Enchiladas
Spanish Rice
Black & Pinto Bean Ole
Chips & Salsa
Brownies
Four Vacuum Packs Enchiladas
Take home for \$ 10.00 per four pack



At

**Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 50th Street South
Minneapolis, MN 55417**

May 20 Youth service project: Local Animal Shelter. The Youth wanted to find ways to serve and help our community in ways they never have before, so we are going to volunteer at a local animal shelter for a day! We will be spending our time cleaning and caring for the animals and learning all that goes on behind the scenes. If you would like to join us for the day please RVSP, parents and friends are always welcome!

In case Camps are not on your calendar yet here our the dates, and please contact Leilani if you have any other questions!

-Minnehaha Adventure Camp: July 16-18 (finished grades 5th & 6th this spring) at Koinonia Retreat Center

-Minnehaha Wilderness Camp: July 23-28 (finished grades 7th-12th this spring) at Star Lake Campgrounds

Leilani Thompson
Director of Youth Ministries

Children's Ministries

As we enter this last month of our program year, we have a lot on our plates:

We wrap up the year with Children's Sunday, celebrating all the volunteers who've worked so hard in our Faith Formation programs, the kids get to lead us in worship, and we take a look back at our year while eating cake and sipping lemonade in the side lawn.

That certainly is enough to keep us all busy, but there is also preparing for the summer: planting and tending our garden, Vacation Bible School, Music & Drama Camp, overnight camps and Cowboy Sunday, worship outside and at the Falls. A break from our regular routine can be welcome and refreshing, and we look forward to a wonderful summer together!

While we take this break, what kind of opportunities are there for continued faith formation?

Worship continues on Sunday Mornings. After a series of one service Sundays (May 21st & 28th, June 4th & 11th), we start our Sunday Service schedule on June 18th. First service is still held in the sanctuary at 9am, while second service is held in the side lawn at 10:30am.

There are also chances for your to **help out with our church community garden** - this opportunity to be together, as a family, and with other families opens not only a chance for service, learning about plants & the earth, but also can lead to conversations about faith and God. Sign up for a week of weeding, tend the garden as a family, and see where that takes you! Or, come to our monthly garden parties to connect with the Minnehaha community.

If connection is what your crave, **attending the Minnehaha Softball Games** is a great option. Held on the Nokomis Fields (just west of Lake Nokomis), the games are a great chance to cheer on our team and visit with others in a beautiful setting.

If you're looking for ideas on how to talk with children about faith, on how to slow down, or on fun projects with kids - **check out the parent section of the Children's Library**, there are great resources for you there. Or, sign up for emails from Sparkhouse Family. Sparkhouse is the publisher of our Sunday School curriculum, and their **Sparkhouse Family site offers a plethora of information** - through emails, webinars, and more - about children & faith. Check out www.sparkhouse.org.

And, of course, mark your calendars for the start of our 2017-2018 Program Year - we'll launch that on Rally Day, September 10th!

We look forward to an exciting month - to seeing you at Children's Sunday, and then throughout the summer. Please let me know if you have any questions, concerns, or ideas for things you'd like to see happening in our next program year.

Thank you,
Jenia Strom
Director of Children & Family Ministries



Procession Easter morning

Highlights from the March 14, 2017 Church Council Meeting

TREASURER'S REPORT: Pledges are coming in (thank you!), all bills have been paid, mortgage payments have been made, and apportionments and interfund loan payments are up-to-date through March 31, 2017. (Dennis Feller, Treasurer)

VOTE TO REAMORTIZE BUILDING LOAN: Every year, Thrivent Financial allows us to reamortize our mortgage loan if we'd like to lower the amount we're required to pay each month. Since we made a significant amount of additional loan payments over the past year, our Treasurer made the case that we should reamortize our loan and continue to prepay as much as we can. The motion passed unanimously. (Dennis Feller, Treasurer)

VOTE ON "WHO IS OUR NEIGHBOR?" LEGISLATION: A motion was made for the church to form a partnership with a Somali family, and to offer our friendship and emotional support, and include them in our prayers. The motion was passed unanimously. This is now an official mission of the church. (Beth and Paul Minehart, Who Is Our Neighbor? Points of Contact)

SPRING SPECIAL APPEAL TO RAISE \$10,000 STARTS ON APRIL 30: At this year's annual meeting in January, the Finance committee included as a budget item a Spring Appeal to raise an additional \$10,000 to balance the budget. The Spring Appeal will begin April 30 and run through May 21. Here's how it works: Two sets of envelopes—each set numbered 1 through 100—will be set out in the Narthex on Sunday mornings. Take an envelope or two (or three), and put a check or cash equal to the number inside the envelope, and place it in the offering plate. (For example, if you pick envelope #64, you'd put in \$64.) When a set of 100 envelopes is filled, the total adds up to \$5,050! So with two sets, we hope to raise \$10,100 to balance the 2017 budget. If you'd like your gift to appear on your giving statement, pay with a check or be sure to include your giving number. (Sue Claude, Finance Chair)

WE'RE GOING SOLAR! Thanks to the tireless work (and luck) of the church's Solar Committee (Chris Kramer, Joan Ellison, Mike Schmidt, Eric Strom and Chris Pow), we won a Made in Minnesota grant that will allow us to install a nearly 40kW photovoltaic system on the roof of our education building. Working with Cooperative Energy Futures of Minnesota, we're able to get the system (and save \$4,000 to \$6,000 in energy costs per year) **AT NO CHARGE TO THE CHURCH.** It's a big deal. Work on the project may begin as soon as this fall. (Kim Kanuit, Trustees Chair)

NEW PLAYGROUND SURFACE IN THE WORKS: We're currently at work exploring a new playground surface for use by the church and Mandala Montessori School. It will likely require a layer of gravel for drainage, geotextile cloth and a 12-inch layer of playground-safe wood mulch. (Gene Thompson, Building & Grounds Chair)

CHECK OUT OUR SUMMER EVENTS FOR KIDS AND YOUTH: There's still time to sign up for summer activities and camps. There's "Hero Central" Vacation Bible School, a morning program for children in preschool through fifth grade from June 21 – 23. Music & Drama Camp, an all-day camp for children who have completed third through eighth grade from June 19 – 23. Methodist summer camps like the Trailblazers 2 hike/canoe/arts/swim camp at Koronis from July 16 – 19. And more! Links for sign-up are on the website, or talk to Jenia. (Jenia Strom, Children's Ministries)

SIMPSON SHELTER ON MAY 22: Minnehaha will serve at Simpson Shelter on May 22. If you'd like to help prep the meal on May 21 or serve on May 22, contact Maureen Trepp. (Maureen Trepp, United Methodist Women)

THREE CHURCHES MEET: Minnehaha United Methodist, St. James Episcopal and Lake Nokomis Lutheran churches continue to meet to discuss how we can all work together to make a stronger impact in the neighborhood. (Maureen Trepp, MUMC Representative)

ST. JAMES EPISCOPAL COMMUNITY GARDEN: St. James Episcopal Church is starting a Community Garden, and the Minnehaha Food Shelf will receive a good portion of the produce. St. James needs volunteers to help build raised bed gardens and plant, so if you're interested, contact Anne Scheible at annebillscheible@gmail.com or (612) 722-0468. Events will take place April 29 (8:30AM – 4:00PM), May 6 or 7 and May 21-22. (Judy Durfey, Food Shelf Chair)

Continued from pg. 6

UPDATING THE YOUTH ROOM: Minnehaha's youth are updating the Youth Room (the "Upper Room" on the Third Floor) with a new coat of paint, new furniture, a TV and (hopefully) some new window dressings. Take a look to see how it's going! (Lani Thompson, Youth Ministries)

NEXT MEETING MAY 9 AT 6:30 PM: The next Church Council meeting is scheduled for May 9 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request.

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

Adopt-a-room

Help us take care of God's house! Inspired by the great turn-out on the Church Cleaning Day on March 11th, we are starting a new adopt-a-room program. Individuals and groups are invited to select one space in the church—a room, a hallway, or even a corner! You would be responsible for keeping an eye on that space, and notifying the church if there is something that needs more attention (like painting). Sign up on the church plan in the narthex, or talk to Val Mayer or Dean Ammerman. You will be a space ambassador—no heavy cleaning required! Working together we can keep our church clean, tidy, and inviting to our guests.

Have a Blessed Ramadan

Once again this year, the Minnesota Council of Churches is providing signs for Christian and Jewish congregations to put in their lawns wishing our Muslim brothers and sister a blessed Ramadan. Once again this year, we will be putting the sign in our lawn. It's a neighborly thing to do, and given our partnership with the Daud family (see *Who Is Our Neighbor* article on next page), it has an added layer of meaning for us this year.

Ramadan is one of the largest Islamic observances. It is a 30-day period which moves around the calendar (this year, it starts at sundown on May 26). It celebrates the first revelation of the Quran to the prophet Mohammad. Ramadan is observed as a time of fasting from all food and drink from sunrise to sunset, and observing Ramadan is one of the five pillars of Islam. Many Muslims time a pilgrimage to Mecca (another of the five pillars) during Ramadan. The observance of Ramadan ends with the celebratory holiday of Eid al-Fitr.

We'll have our sign up for all of Ramadan this year – when you see it, or others like it in your neighborhood – remember to hold our Muslim brothers and sisters, especially the Dauds, in prayer.

Wear Red!

Pentecost is the celebration of the birthday of the church, and it is traditional to wear red that day (red symbolizes the flames of the Holy Spirit). This year, we will celebrate Pentecost on June 4 (remember, one service at 10:00 that day, outside), so come and wear some red!



**Join us at Minnehaha for
Wednesday Night Suppers!**

Throughout the winter and spring, join us for supper from 5:30-6:30 in the Fellowship Hall.

Cost for Dinner:
\$5 for those 4 years and older
Free for children under 4
Family Cap: \$20
PURCHASE A PUNCH CARD & RECEIVE FOUR MEALS FREE!

Following dinner, there is programming for children from 6:15 to 7pm.



It's Minnehaha Garden Time!

This morning, we'll be planting seeds in the narthex for the Minnehaha Garden.

Our Sunday School students will be nurturing these seeds over the next month, and then we will transplant them into the garden on May 21st.

All are invited and encouraged to join us in the tending to and reaping from our garden.

If you are interested in being a part of the garden planning team, or wish to be a part of our summer tending schedule, please contact Jenia Strom at jeniastrom@gmail.com.



United
Methodist
Women

United Methodist Women

- Please join us on May 6 for our annual Salad Luncheon. We will be celebrating those in our congregation who are 90 years old or more! A Greater Generation Birthday Party! The fun begins at 11:00 with stories, songs and memories followed by cake and salad. If you would like to bring a salad to share, please let Stacia Nelson know and bring it that day. If you have a family member older than 90 who would like to come and we haven't contacted them, please tell Maureen Trepp you are bringing someone and come! Lunch for adults is \$8 and \$4 for children under 12.
- May 22 is the last scheduled serving evening at Simpson Shelter until next fall. If you would like to help out, please contact Maureen Trepp at 612-724-7620. We begin around 5:45 and usually finish up by 8:00. We hope to add more dates next year as this mission may be a part of Nokomis Serves.
- Be sure to order your potted or hanging plant from the UMW. They will be delivered the weekend of May 6-7. See ad in this newsletter.

Monthly Communion at Nokomis Sq.

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., Becky offers a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of the chapter we are reading for the week in *We Make The Road By Walking*. Anyone is welcome to come. This month we will be gathering on May 11.

Taizé Worship

For some of you, the Sunday morning worship does not provide enough time for quiet, reflection, prayer and silence. We invite you to feed your soul with our monthly Taizé Service. The service is modeled after the worship services at the ecumenical community of Taizé, located in eastern France. The service has prayer, scripture, music, and silence. The songs have few words, sung repetitively, in order to allow for deep contemplation and prayer. Join us on Friday, May 12, at 7:00. Taizé will then be on hiatus for the summer, resuming in October.

WE GOT IT!

Minnehaha solar committee has some exciting news to announce, the church will be the recipient of the Made in Minnesota solar incentive program. What does this mean...it means that the church will receive a 40kW solar array (roof top panels) on the education wing of the building at NO COST to the church. It is projected to cover about 40% of our current energy use per year. This program will be implemented by two groups (Cooperative Energy Futures and Innovative Power Systems) that the solar committee has been working with for the last year. We expect the panels to be installed within the year so watch for further updates. This is a very exciting time for our church as we continue to look for ways to seek, serve and celebrate in our community and our world. Please feel free to reach out to any of us on the solar committee if you have any questions.

Regards, the Solar Committee: Chris Kramer, Joan Ellison, Mike Schmidt, Eric Strom, Chris Pow

Who Is Our Neighbor?

At our April Church Council meeting, Minnehaha voted to formally begin a new mission project – a partnership with the Daud family. The Dauds are Somali refugees who have lived in the United States for a number of years now, and they have an adult son in prison. The imprisonment of their son has led to their isolation in what used to be their communities of connection, and so Minnehaha is stepping into that gap. We will provide emotional support, and hold the family in our prayers. Right now, we are working on getting to know the Dauds, and for them to get to know us. They have attended a Wednesday night dinner here, a number of folks have been to their house for tea, and you are welcome to frequent their restaurant – the Daud Diner in the Karmel Mall. (Karmel Mall is a Somali mall in south Minneapolis.) As opportunities arise in the future, we will be sure to let you know about them.

We also ask that you don't speak to the press about the Daud family. If you are approached by any press, please tell them you have no comment, and refer them to the church office. The Dauds have had a number of bad experiences with the press, even with press that said they were writing a positive story about their experiences. So, out of respect for them in our partnership, we ask that you don't talk to the press. You can talk about your experience in this partnership to your friends and families and neighbors, just not to the press. Also, if you talk to folks in other churches who are interested in entering into a similar partnership, let the office know; there are more opportunities for partnering with families who have sons in prison.

United or Divided Methodist Church?

Our denomination is at a crossroads. At the last world-wide gathering of our denomination in 2016, a commission was formed to help us try to find a way forward – they are tasked with coming up with a proposal that will come before our denomination prior to our 2020 General Conference. Whether we stay the United Methodist Church (with some major changes, and probably some groups that will break off) or officially divide into 2 or more denominations is in our foreseeable future. To hear more about this process, how we got here, and where we might be going, come to church on Wednesday, May 3 to hear from Dave Nuckols. Dave was at the 2016 General Conference and is one of the people appointed to the commission. May 3 is also the night of our enchilada dinner, so come for enchiladas starting at 5:00, and Dave will begin his presentation at 6:00. He will be done by 7:30.

Honest to John

John Darlington is continuing to lead the Thursday morning 10am – 11am class. “Honest to John” is an exploration of the New Testament using the Gospel According to John as perspective. The class will conclude on June 1.

Workshop on Maximizing Social Security on May 4 @ 6:00 PM

You're invited to a special workshop at the church on Thursday, May 4 at 6:00 PM on Social Security: Strategize to Maximize. Get positive, professional guidance from Thrivent Financial representatives Anne Kersten and Chase Lapan. To reserve a place, call Debra Teske at (952) 658-6221 or email: debra.teske@thrivent.com.

One Service Sundays

We will be having one service at 10:00 for these four weeks:

- May 21 – one service inside at 10:00 for the Children's Musical
- May 28 – one service inside at 10:00. Memorial Day weekend.
- June 4 – one service outside at 10:00 with a blessing of bike helmets and a potluck picnic outside following the service
- June 11 – one service inside at 10:00 to celebrate our graduating seniors with a special coffee hour in their honor following the service

Our summer schedule of 9:00 indoors and 10:30 outdoors will begin on Sunday, June 18.

Blessing of Bikes (and helmets)

June 4 will be a special service to bless bikes and bike helmets. We'll be having one worship service at 10:00, outside, and a picnic following the service. You can ride your bike to church, bring your bike, or just bring your bike helmet and we'll make sure whatever you bring gets a blessing.

“Will Party” on Wednesday evening, May 24 at Minnehaha

On Thursday, May 24, from 6:00 pm to 8:00 pm, Minnehaha UMC will host another “Will Party.” This event will provide an opportunity for those who wish to start or revise a will to meet with an attorney.

Steve Otto of Otto Law (www.ottoesq.com), a Twin Cities law firm focusing on estate planning/probate administration and business law, will be at the meeting to talk about wills, answer your questions, and to meet one-on-one to discuss your estate planning needs. (There is no charge for this initial consultation.) If you would like to have a will drawn up or do other estate planning, you can set up a follow-up meeting.

A light supper will be served at the meeting. Childcare will be provided upon request. To make a reservation or with questions regarding this event, please call: David Graham at 612-721-0333 or Kim Kanuit at 612-860-0256.

Moving Seniors to Move

Accidental falls can be the pivotal even causing lasting change in mobility, independence, health, and well-being. Physical activity is the key to maintain strength and balance. Join others for conversation as well as exercises to improve balance and mobility on Tuesday and Thursday mornings at 9:00 am in Room 304.



It's coming soon...

**SUNDAY, 21st MAY:
CHILDREN'S SUNDAY at
MINNEHAHA UMC**

We worship together with
ONE SERVICE ONLY at 10am

We hope you can join us as:
the Children of Minnehaha lead worship
& present the musical "What's Up Zak!",
we recognize & celebrate our many wonderful
Faith Formation Volunteers,
we plant our raised bed gardens,
& we enjoy cake and lemonade in the side yard.



Join Us for a Birthday Party to Celebrate the Greatest Generation



Come all of you
born in 1927
or earlier with
your family and
friends, men
and women, for
festivities.

**\$8 for Adults
\$4 for Children**

An event hosted by the United Methodist Women.

Saturday, May 6 @ 11:00 a.m.

Memories • Salad • Cake

Minnehaha United Methodist Church • 3701 East 50th Street, Mpls. MN

Potluck Lunch

We are kicking off summer with a potluck following the worship service on June 4 (one service that day, 10:00, outside). We'll have the grills going, so bring something to grill and a side dish or dessert to share. Kids are welcome to play on the playground, and everyone is welcome to admire the raised garden beds. You can see what's growing, pay attention to what flowers are about to bloom, and pick any weeds you find. If it's raining, we'll move the whole thing into the Fellowship Hall.

Summer is approaching and that means:

**The Minnehaha UMC Softball Season
is about to start!**

When: Doubleheaders Sunday Nights – Games at 5pm & 6pm on:
May 7th & 21st
June 11th & 25th
July 16th & 30th

Where: Nokomis Fields

Who: This is an adult recreation league through the City of Minneapolis; adults are invited to join the team – families & anyone not interested in playing are encouraged to come, cheer, and connect with one another!

Interested or have questions?
Contact Mike Schow at 612.886.4034 or k82816@netzero.com



Handbell choir Easter morning



Church Cycles

I like the liturgical seasons of the church year. They come around every year, sort of like our climatological seasons. And, just like our climatological seasons, I'm not always ready for their appearance. I've spent many a hot and humid summer day wishing it were fall or winter so that I could curl up with a good book under a blanket in front of a fire. Although I often get excited about the first snowstorm in November, I know that I am rarely excited by a similar event in late March or April. In the church cycle, I'm not always in the right mood for the season either. Advent doesn't always find me in the mood for preparation, and I have spent some very unreflective times in Lent. Summer doesn't always feel like ordinary time, and I don't always have epiphanies during Epiphany. But I like the reminder of the many phases life, and of how church, communal, and individual life can also be cyclical. The church year begins with Advent, the four weeks before Christmas. From there, we move into the one or two Sundays of the Christmas season, then on to Epiphany, Lent, Easter, Pentecost, and ordinary time until we get to Advent again. Advent and Lent are seasons of preparation for Christmas and Easter, and ordinary time fills the spaces in between. Pentecost seems like a good excuse for a party, but sadly, the season only lasts for the one Sunday. In the liturgical year, we are currently in the season of Easter. Although Christmas only gets one or two Sundays, we recognize the Easter season for seven Sundays. The season is even phrased carefully – the Sundays of Easter. Not the Sundays after Easter, but the Sundays of Easter. It all comes to an end on Pentecost – June 4 this year – but the Sundays of Easter remind me that resurrection is not a one-time event, but an on-going one. Resurrection can happen in so many different places in my life. I can experience it in the blooming of a spring tulip, in a harvest moon, in a sudden snowfall, in the laughter of a friend, in the unexpected kindness of a stranger in the check-out line, in a moment of unexpected quiet, and sometimes even sitting in traffic. As we move from Easter to Pentecost, our church year changes its focus, but I'll still be looking for those moments of resurrection, just as I sometimes experience the rebirth of the church in Advent.

In joy,
Becky



Dylan Francis Conklin was baptized Easter morning



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Join us for 2017 Summer Programming at Minnehaha UMC

Music and Drama Camp June 19th-June 23rd

An all-day camp for children
who have completed third through eighth grade.
Campers will spend the week working on all aspects of a musical production,
which will feature the songs and stories of Sandra Boynton.



Hero Central:

Discover Your Strength in God! Vacation Bible School

June 21st-June 23rd

A morning program for children
in preschool through fifth grade

An opportunity for kids to grow and learn through games, arts
& crafts, music, and more. Extended afternoon daycare
available.

Summer Camps through Camp Minnesota

Overnight camps for elementary children.

Join with other children from around the Minnesota Conference for
summer camp. We'll hike, canoe, do arts and crafts, swim, have
campfires, and learn about God and the world around us.

A group will be attending Trailblazers 2 at Koronis (July 16-19) if
you'd like to attend with other Minnehaha campers. Register soon to get your space!



Questions? Contact Jenia Strom at education@minnehaha.org/612.721.6231
Register at www.minnehaha.org for VBS & Music & Drama Camp and at
www.campminnesota.org for overnight camps